

Rappaccini's Daughter

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1844

First published: Democratic Review, Dec 1844

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Mosses_from_an_Old_Manse/Rappaccini's_Daughter (revision 11868101), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 11–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). Middle School prompts use the full text when the grade tags include 6–8; otherwise teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about science and nature?
- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about love and poison?
- What does Rappaccini's Daughter suggest about innocence?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the story.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one

essay of the five

Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.

Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Rappaccini's Daughter	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*science and nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Rappaccini's Daughter

Author biography

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden (he added the "w" to his name). After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

Historical and cultural context

Set in Padua, Italy, home to one of Europe's oldest botanical gardens (founded 1545), the story draws on Renaissance medicine and an old legend of a "poison maiden" raised on poison. Hawthorne was suspicious of scientists who treated people as experiments.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the United States Magazine and Democratic Review in December 1844 under the pseudonym "M. de l'Aubépine" ("hawthorn" in French); collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846).

Then: Admired by a small literary circle.

Now: Studied as an allegory of science without morality and of love that cannot trust.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A young student, Giovanni, falls in love with Beatrice, the beautiful daughter of a scientist whose garden is full of strange poisonous plants.

Main themes

- science without conscience.
- love and trust.
- nature versus the artificial.

Why it matters

Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.

Spoilers · teacher only

Beatrice has been made poisonous by her father; Giovanni finds that he too has become poisonous and offers her an antidote, but it kills her; she dies asking whether there was not more poison in his nature than in hers.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)

Before we open Rappaccini's Daughter: Should scientists be able to experiment on people they love "for their own good"?
Prompt: Before we open Rappaccini's Daughter: Should scientists be able to experiment on people they love "for their own good"?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

allegory; Gothic; symbol; foil; Eden.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden (he added the "w" to his name). After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. Set in Padua, Italy, home to one of Europe's oldest botanical gardens (founded 1545), the story draws on Renaissance medicine and an old legend of a "poison maiden" raised on poison. Hawthorne was suspicious of scientists who treated people as experiments. Publication and reception. First published in the United States Magazine and Democratic Review in December 1844 under the pseudonym "M. de l'Aubépine" ("hawthorn" in French); collected in Mosses from an Old Manse (1846). Then: Admired by a small literary circle. Now: Studied as an allegory of science without morality and of love that cannot trust.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22). Giovanni's view.

> *Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world* (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22)

Think-aloud: "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22). Giovanni's view.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): A young student, Giovanni, falls in love with Beatrice, the beautiful daughter of a scientist whose garden is full of strange poisonous plants. Themes to track: science without conscience.: love and trust.: nature versus the artificial.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question.
Task: Set up a reading journal for Rappaccini's Daughter: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Rappaccini's Daughter still matter? Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.
Anchor question: Why might Rappaccini's Daughter still be taught today?
Facilitation: Today's debates about genetic engineering and medical ethics echo the story.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Who is most responsible for Beatrice's death? Answer: Arguments for Rappaccini (the experiment), Baglioni (the antidote and rivalry) or Giovanni (distrust) all hold up with evidence.
Exit ticket: Who is most responsible for Beatrice's death?
Answer: Arguments for Rappaccini (the experiment), Baglioni (the antidote and rivalry) or Giovanni (distrust) all hold up with evidence.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: Rappaccini's Daughter.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Hawthorne, Mosses from an Old Manse (1846) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/512)

Lesson 2: Rappaccini's Daughter

Focus: science that poisons love

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in “Rappaccini's Daughter” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: CCSS RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4 · IN 9-10.RC.12, 9-10.W.1, 9-10.RC.9, 9-10.RC.11

Content note (poisoning, death): Sensitive content: Poisoning; death. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes poisoning; death.
Suggested language: “Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni turns on Beatrice; she drinks the antidote and dies, the poison having been her life. Baglioni cries out at Rappaccini's 'experiment.'

Background: Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden.

Significance: An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to love and trust because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes poisoning; death.
Prompt: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to love and trust because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
*Today's words: inhaled — breathed in; blossomed — developed; grew and flourished; enticed — tempted; attracted; assuage — cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of; alighting — to come to rest, settle. “inhaled”: From Latin inhalare "to breathe on (breathe in)", from in "in, into, on" + halare "to breathe". “assuage”: From Middle English aswagen, from Old French asuagier "to appease, to calm", from Vulgar Latin *assuāviō "to sweeten, to butter up, to calm", derived from Latin ad- + suāvis "sweet" + -iō. “alighting”: From Middle English alighten "to descend from a place: to dismount, get off; to descend to a place: to arrive or stop (at a place); to land; to drop; to attack; of lightning: to strike; to leap on to, mount; to descend in rank; to cause (someone) to lose rank; to come forth, spring from; to alleviate, relieve; (Christianity) of Jesus: to come down to earth from heaven, become incarnate; to descend*
Words: inhaled: breathed in · blossomed: developed; grew and flourished · enticed: tempted; attracted · assuage: cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of · alighting: to come to rest, settle

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden. An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein. Setting: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly. Symbolism: The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous. Characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Watch for the garden: knowledge and sin, as in Eden.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22). Giovanni's question. That is setting at work: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.

> *Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world* (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22). Giovanni's question. That is setting at work: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Beatrice's question reverses who is the victim: Giovanni's distrust was the real poison. Ask: How does this line connect to love and trust? Expected: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. (Her accusation.)

> *was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine* (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Beatrice's question reverses who is the victim: Giovanni's distrust was the real poison.
Ask: How does this line connect to love and trust?
Expected answer: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. (Her accusation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. When the text says “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311), it shows this directly. She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.
Task: Annotate the story for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. When the text says “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311), it shows this directly. She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits? Ask: is Beatrice innocent? Use evidence from her conversations with Giovanni.
Anchor question: Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
Facilitation: Ask: is Beatrice innocent? Use evidence from her conversations with Giovanni.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. ("was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine", Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about science that poisons love? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. ("was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine", Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes science that poisons love. Key takeaway: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.
- **Symbolism:** The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous.
- **Characterization:** Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror.

Themes and how they develop

- **love and trust:** Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

Symbols and motifs

- **the garden:** knowledge and sin, as in Eden.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) Giovanni's question.
- "I would fain have been loved, not feared" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Beatrice's dying words.
- "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Her accusation.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison.
Evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311)
Reasoning: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
inhaled (verb)	breathed in	*As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided.*	“inhaled”: From Latin inhalare "to breathe on (breathe in)", from in "in, into, on" + halare "to breathe". (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inhale#Etymology)
blossomed (verb)	developed; grew and flourished	*But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath.*	
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of*	
assuage (verb)	cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of	*Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to accelerate itself to a race.*	“assuage”: From Middle English aswagen, from Old French asuagier "to appease, to calm", from Vulgar Latin *assuāviō "to sweeten, to butter up, to calm", derived from Latin ad- + suāvis "sweet" + -iō. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/assuage#Etymology)
alighting (verb)	to come to rest, settle	*Without alighting on the flowers, this winged brightness seemed to be attracted by Beatrice, and lingered in the air and fluttered about her head.*	“alighting”: From Middle English alighten "to descend from a place: to dismount, get off; to descend to a place: to arrive or stop (at a place); to land; to drop; to attack; of lightning: to strike; to leap on to, mount; to descend in rank; to cause (someone) to lose rank; to come forth, spring from; to alleviate, relieve; (Christianity) of Jesus: to come down to earth from heaven, become incarnate; to descend (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/alight#Etymology)

tingling (verb)	prickling or stinging slightly	*When thoroughly aroused, he became sensible of a burning and tingling agony in his hand--in his right hand--the very hand which Beatrice had grasped in her own when he was on the point of plucking one of the gemlike flowers.*	
cultivating (verb)	foster the growth of	*It was strangely frightful to the young man's imagination to see this air of insecurity in a person cultivating a garden, that most simple and innocent of human toils, and which had been alike the joy and labor of the unfallen parents of the race.*	
equanimity (noun)	steadiness of mind under stress	*But now there was a singular and untimely equanimity within his breast.*	“equanimity”: From French équanimité, from Latin aequanimitās "calmness, equanimity", from aequus "even; calm; fair" + animus "mind, soul" + -itās. By surface analysis, en + equ + animus + ity. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/equanimity#Etymology)
alluding (verb)	make a more or less disguised reference to	*"You are a connoisseur in flowers, signor," said Beatrice, with a smile, alluding to the bouquet which he had flung her from the window. "It is no marvel, therefore, if the sight of my father's rare collection has tempted you to take a nearer view.*	“alluding”: From Middle French alluder, from Latin alludere "to play with or allude", from ad + ludere "to play". See also al-#Etymology_2. (Wiktionary, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/allude#Etymology)
apothecary (noun)	a person who prepared and sold medicines and gave medical advice	*"Ay; but my sober imagination does not often play such tricks," said Baglioni; "and, were I to fancy any kind of odor, it would be that of some vile apothecary drug, wherewith my fingers are likely enough to be imbued.*	

Discussion questions

1. Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with science and nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the story take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Padua, Italy
2. What is unusual about Beatrice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She is poisonous to touch and breath
3. Who gives Giovanni the antidote? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Professor Baglioni
4. What happens to Giovanni over time? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He also becomes poisonous
5. What happens when Beatrice drinks the antidote? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She dies
6. Retell the three most important events of “Rappaccini's Daughter” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni turns on Beatrice; she drinks the antidote and dies, the poison having been her life. Baglioni…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Rappaccini's Daughter” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided.” What does “inhaled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: inhaled: breathed in.
10. Reread: “But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath.” What does “blossomed” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: blossomed: developed; grew and flourished.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Rappaccini's Daughter” suggest about science that poisons love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein.
2. Find one example of symbolism in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
3. How does the allusion in this story shape what we understand about science that poisons love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Rappaccini's Daughter”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Student Giovanni Guasconti, lodging in Padua, watches Beatrice, daughter of the scientist Rappaccini, tend a garden of poisonous plants. He falls in love though her touch and breath kill insects and flowers. Professor Baglioni warns him and gives an antidote. Finding himself poisonous too, Giovanni…
6. As the opening story, what does “Rappaccini's Daughter” set up that the rest of Rappaccini's Daughter will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: "Should scientists ever experiment on people they love? Where are the limits?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with science and nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1844; set in Renaissance Padua, home of Europe's first botanical garden. The garden echoes Eden. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "I would fain have been loved, not feared" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. On setting: The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "An early literary warning about scientific ambition, often paired with Frankenstein." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world" (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. On characterization: Baglioni and Rappaccini are rival scientists; Giovanni's love wavers between attraction and horror. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Rappaccini's Daughter" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about science that poisons love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: "I would fain have been loved, not feared"

(Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Rappaccini's Daughter”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to love and poison: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the symbolism in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. On symbolism: The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Rappaccini's Daughter” treats science that poisons love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Rappaccini's Daughter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve science and nature? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22): Giovanni's question. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about science that poisons love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Beatrice's dying words. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Nathaniel Hawthorne about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Useful evidence: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311): Her accusation. Theme link: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is unusual about Beatrice?
   A. She is blind
   B. She is a ghost
   C. She is poisonous to touch and breath
   D. She cannot speak

   Key: C (She is poisonous to touch and breath)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When thoroughly aroused, he became sensible of a burning and _____ agony in his hand--in his right hand--the very hand which Beatrice had grasped in her own when he was on the point of plucking one of the gemlike flowers.” Word bank: tingling, enticed, inhaled, blossomed
   Key: tingling
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the _____ world”
   Key: present
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Without _____ on the flowers, this winged brightness seemed to be attracted by Beatrice, and lingered in the air and fluttered about her head.” Word bank: inhaled, blossomed, alighting, enticed
   Key: alighting

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who gives Giovanni the antidote?

   A. Beatrice

   B. Rappaccini

   C. Professor Baglioni

   D. Lisabetta

   Key: C (Professor Baglioni)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311: “was there not, from the first, more _____ in thy nature than in mine”

   Key: poison

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when Beatrice drinks the antidote?

   A. She escapes

   B. She is cured

   C. She becomes more poisonous

   D. She dies

   Key: D (She dies)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the story take place?

   A. Rome

   B. Florence

   C. Padua, Italy

   D. Venice

   Key: C (Padua, Italy)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Giovanni over time?

   A. He becomes immune

   B. He goes blind

   C. He forgets Beatrice

   D. He also becomes poisonous

   Key: D (He also becomes poisonous)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311: “I would fain have been loved, not _____”

    Key: feared

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Giovanni's question.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Rappaccini's Daughter”?

    A. Science that poisons love

    B. Friendship tested by duty

    C. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

D. The art of the deadpan tall tale

Key: A (Science that poisons love)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Simile

    C. Imagery

    D. Setting

    Key: D (Setting)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311).

    Sample answer: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Giovanni's question.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was strangely frightful to the young man's imagination to see this air of insecurity in a person _____ a garden, that most simple and innocent of human toils, and which had been alike the joy and labor of the unfallen parents of the race.”

    Word bank: cultivating, enticed, blossomed, inhaled

    Key: cultivating

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Her accusation.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words.

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous.

    A. Point of view

    B. Personification

    C. Symbolism

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Symbolism)

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and trust develops from an earlier story to “Rappaccini's Daughter”. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But now there was a singular and untimely _____ within his breast.” Word bank: blossomed, inhaled, enticed, equanimity

    Key: equanimity

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to…”, what does “assuage” most nearly mean?

    A. developed; grew and flourished

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

    Key: D (cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “But I, dearest Giovanni,--I grew up and blossomed with the plant and was nourished with its breath.”, what does “blossomed” most nearly mean?

    A. tempted; attracted

    B. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

    C. developed; grew and flourished

    D. breathed in

    Key: C (developed; grew and flourished)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 17, 10, 1, 9, 7, 2, 4, 8, 13, 12, 11, 15, 14, 18, 19	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 10, 2, 7, 8, 9, 1, 3, 12, 13, 11, 20, 18, 14, 16, 21	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 3, 5, 9, 4, 22, 7, 11, 12, 13, 18, 20, 15, 14, 16, 23	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 2, 22, 6, 17, 1, 11, 12, 13, 15, 14, 18, 20, 21, 23, 19	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	2, 6, 22, 8, 24, 13, 11, 12, 14, 20, 15, 18, 21, 16, 19, 23	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	10, 2, 5, 7, 9, 13, 12, 11, 20, 14, 18, 15, 23, 19, 16, 21	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 1, 7, 5, 4, 13, 11, 12, 20, 14, 15, 18, 19, 21, 23, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	25, 2, 17, 3, 22, 11, 13, 12, 14, 20, 15, 18, 21, 23, 19, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	4, 22, 7, 24, 1, 12, 13, 11, 18, 20, 15, 14, 19, 23, 21, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	8, 10, 2, 7, 1, 11, 13, 12, 20, 15, 14, 18, 23, 16, 21, 19	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Rappaccini's Daughter,” how does Hawthorne show science that poisons love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Rappaccini's Daughter, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of science that poisons love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Rappaccini's Daughter develops the idea of science that poisons love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of science that poisons love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Rappaccini's Daughter suggests about science that poisons love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's symbolism and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in Rappaccini's Daughter to complicate the reader's understanding of science that poisons love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1): Situate Rappaccini's Daughter within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of science that poisons love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1): Read Rappaccini's Daughter alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of science that poisons love follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Rappaccini's Daughter and its treatment of science that poisons love. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's symbolism and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1): Develop a research argument that reads Rappaccini's Daughter as evidence for a larger claim about science that poisons love in Rappaccini's Daughter. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1): Develop an original argument that reads Rappaccini's Daughter as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of science that poisons love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Rappaccini's Daughter.

SAT-style questions

1. *from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of*

   As used in the text, what does the word “enticed” most nearly mean?

   A. steadiness of mind under stress

   B. a person who prepared and sold medicines and gave medical advice

   C. make a more or less disguised reference to

   D. tempted; attracted

2. *Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to accelerate itself to a race. One day he found himself arrested; his arm was seized by a portly personage, who had turned back on recognizing the young man and expended much breath in overtaking him.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Rappaccini's Daughter”?

   A. Refusal as a mystery the narrator cannot solve

   B. Science that poisons love

   C. Racial pride destroying love

   D. Endurance turning to justice

SAT key: 1. D (tempted; attracted); 2. B (Science that poisons love)

Unit test

Rappaccini's Daughter: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Middle School and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311: “was there not, from the first, more _____ in thy nature than in mine”
   Key: poison
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311: “I would fain have been loved, not _____”
   Key: feared
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Where does the story take place?
   A. Rome
   B. Florence
   C. Padua, Italy
   D. Venice

   Key: C (Padua, Italy)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “When thoroughly aroused, he became sensible of a burning and _____ agony in his hand--in his right hand--the very hand which Beatrice had grasped in her own when he was on the point of plucking one of the gemlike flowers.” Word bank: tingling, enticed, inhaled, blossomed
   Key: tingling
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Without _____ on the flowers, this winged brightness seemed to be attracted by Beatrice, and lingered in the air and fluttered about her head.”
   Word bank: inhaled, blossomed, alighting, enticed
   Key: alighting
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What is unusual about Beatrice?
   A. She is blind
   B. She is a ghost
   C. She is poisonous to touch and breath
   D. She cannot speak

   Key: C (She is poisonous to touch and breath)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Who gives Giovanni the antidote?

   A. Beatrice

   B. Rappaccini

   C. Professor Baglioni

   D. Lisabetta

   Key: C (Professor Baglioni)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens to Giovanni over time?

   A. He becomes immune

   B. He goes blind

   C. He forgets Beatrice

   D. He also becomes poisonous

   Key: D (He also becomes poisonous)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when Beatrice drinks the antidote?

   A. She escapes

   B. She is cured

   C. She becomes more poisonous

   D. She dies

   Key: D (She dies)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22: “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the _____ world”

    Key: present

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was strangely frightful to the young man's imagination to see this air of insecurity in a person _____ a garden, that most simple and innocent of human toils, and which had been alike the joy and labor of the unfallen parents of the race.”

    Word bank: cultivating, enticed, blossomed, inhaled

    Key: cultivating

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But now there was a singular and untimely _____ within his breast.” Word bank: blossomed, inhaled, enticed, equanimity

    Key: equanimity

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Giovanni's question.

14. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Rappaccini's Daughter”?

    A. Science that poisons love

    B. Friendship tested by duty

    C. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

    D. The art of the deadpan tall tale

    Key: A (Science that poisons love)

15. [short · inference · DOK 2] What can you infer from this line? “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words.

16. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? The garden is an artificial Eden: beautiful and deadly.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Simile
    C. Imagery
    D. Setting

    Key: D (Setting)

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311).
    Sample answer: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Was this garden, then, the Eden of the present world” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Giovanni's question.

19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3] Which literary element does this describe in “Rappaccini's Daughter”? The purple shrub is Beatrice's "sister"; both are beautiful and poisonous.
    A. Point of view
    B. Personification
    C. Symbolism
    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: C (Symbolism)

20. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how love and trust develops from an earlier story to “Rappaccini's Daughter”. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Giovanni cannot trust what he cannot understand.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Her accusation.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I would fain have been loved, not feared” (Rappaccini's Daughter, paragraph 311) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Beatrice's dying words.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Evaluate this claim about the story: “Beatrice's body is poisonous, but Hawthorne suggests that Giovanni's suspicion is the deadlier poison.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: She asks, "was there not, from the first, more poison in thy nature than in mine," and says "I would fain have been loved, not feared"; it is Giovanni's fear, not her poison, that leads to her death.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “from all the warmth of life and enticed me into thy region of”, what does “enticed” most nearly mean?

    A. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. developed; grew and flourished

    Key: B (tempted; attracted)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “As Beatrice came down the garden path, it was observable that she handled and inhaled the odor of several of the plants which her father had most sedulously avoided.”, what does “inhaled” most nearly mean?

    A. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. developed; grew and flourished

    Key: C (breathed in)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1] In the line “Sometimes he endeavored to assuage the fever of his spirit by a rapid walk through the streets of Padua or beyond its gates: his footsteps kept time with the throbbings of his brain, so that the walk was apt to…”, what does “assuage” most nearly mean?

    A. developed; grew and flourished

    B. tempted; attracted

    C. breathed in

    D. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

    Key: D (cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Middle School	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 12, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 6, 4, 12, 1, 2, 9, 7, 5, 11, 10, 15, 13, 14, 17, 16, 19, 20	recall 11, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 11, 3, 1, 12, 7, 10, 6, 4, 5, 15, 13, 14, 16, 19, 21, 22, 18	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	11, 10, 9, 5, 7, 3, 8, 6, 12, 14, 13, 15, 16, 21, 17, 19, 23, 20	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 5, 12, 11, 1, 9, 7, 10, 15, 14, 13, 21, 19, 16, 17, 18, 23, 22	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 24, 4, 6, 5, 3, 25, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 19, 21, 18, 23, 20, 22	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 12, 24, 5, 10, 4, 26, 13, 14, 15, 19, 21, 16, 17, 23, 18, 22, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	12, 26, 24, 10, 9, 6, 25, 15, 13, 14, 19, 16, 21, 17, 18, 23, 22, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Junior	25, 6, 11, 26, 2, 3, 24, 13, 15, 14, 19, 17, 21, 16, 22, 18, 23, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	7, 4, 11, 10, 1, 25, 6, 14, 15, 13, 17, 16, 19, 21, 23, 18, 22, 20	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	25, 7, 26, 10, 12, 2, 4, 13, 14, 15, 19, 21, 16, 17, 22, 20, 18, 23	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4

Final paper

Rappaccini's Daughter: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Rappaccini's Daughter and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to love and poison.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Rappaccini's Daughter finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of innocence. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Middle School 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.
Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.

Essay assignments

Essay: Science and nature

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about science and nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops science and nature across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of science and nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of science and nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of science and nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on science and nature in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Love and poison

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about love and poison. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops love and poison across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of love and poison. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of love and poison, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of love and poison in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on love and poison in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Innocence

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rappaccini's Daughter teaches about innocence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops innocence across Rappaccini's Daughter. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rappaccini's Daughter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of innocence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in Rappaccini's Daughter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of innocence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rappaccini's Daughter's treatment of innocence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on innocence in Rappaccini's Daughter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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